

Risk Assessment No: WP-007				Task: Filter Press — Operation and Cloth Change							
Prepared By: Derick Bibby				Date: 02.08.2026			RA Review Date: 01.08.2027				
				Reviewed By: Lee Hardy			Date: 02.08.2026				
PPE: Safety Footwear, High Visibility Jacket, High Visibility Trousers, Hard Hat, Gloves, Ear Defenders, Mask, Eye Protection											
Hazard	Persons at Risk	L	S	R	Control Measures				L	S	R
Stored hydraulic energy on filter press manifold	Maintenance	3	5	15	- Bleed accumulator to zero pressure before opening any manifold. - Confirm pressure gauge reads zero and dump valve is open. - Padlock isolator on filter-press power pack. - Never bypass safety interlocks on plate closing / opening cycle.				1	5	5
Crush injury between filter plates during opening	Operator Maintenance	3	5	15	- Automatic plate-shifter only; no manual plate movement while press is powered. - Guarded plate stack — plate-shifter operates behind interlock. - Never place hands or head between plates for any reason without full LOTO. - Cloth changes carried out with press fully open and locked off.				1	5	5
Manual handling / awkward postures during cloth change	Maintenance	4	3	12	- Two-person operation for cloth change — never single-person. - Cloth-lifting handle or cradle to support cloth during removal. - Anti-fatigue matting at filter-press deck; step-platform available. - Task rotated so no worker changes cloths for > 2 hours continuously.				2	3	6
Contact with hot filter cake and pressurised residues	Maintenance Loader driver	3	3	9	- Allow cake to discharge fully before manual intervention. - Long-cuffed heat-resistant gloves when handling residual cake near plates. - Discard skip positioned to catch fallen cake — no reach into press body.				1	3	3
Chemical exposure — flocculant, lubricants, coolants, hydraulic fluid	Maintenance Operator	3	3	9	- COSHH assessment for every chemical on site; SDS held at MCC and maintenance office. - Chemical-resistant gloves and eye/face protection during handling and dosing. - Bunded storage; spill kits at each storage point. - Emergency eyewash station at MCC and picking station. - Waste chemicals disposed via licensed contractor; consignment notes retained.				1	3	3
Stored energy — hydraulic accumulators, pneumatic receivers	Maintenance Contractors	3	5	15	- Bleed hydraulic accumulators to zero pressure and confirm via gauge before opening manifolds. - Drain air receivers to zero via test valve before hose or fitting removal. - Padlock the isolator on the pump or compressor supplying the circuit. - PSSR examination of accumulators and receivers at statutory interval.				1	5	5

Manual handling of screen media, cloths, cyclone parts, hoses	Maintenance Operator	4	3	12	- Task-based manual handling assessment for screen cloths, cyclone apex and filter-press cloths. - Mechanical lifting (chain block, telehandler, MEWP with man-basket) for loads > 20 kg. - Two-person lift protocol for awkward items. - LOLER-inspected lifting accessories only.	2	2	4
---	----------------------	---	---	----	--	---	---	---